

Micah 1:1

¹ These are the messages that Yahweh gave to Micah, who was from {the town of} Moresheth {in Judah}. Yahweh gave these messages to Micah during the time when Jotham, {then} Ahaz, and {then} Hezekiah ruled as kings of Judah. These are messages about what Yahweh showed Micah would happen to Samaria and to Jerusalem.

² Hear this, all you people everywhere on the earth! The Lord Yahweh is about to testify against you from the holy place where he rules {in heaven}.

³ But now look! Yahweh is about to come out from heaven and come down to the earth where he will walk on the tops of the mountains.

⁴ {He is so powerful that it will be as though} the mountains will melt beneath him as easily as wax melts near a fire and as quickly as water rushes down a hillside, and the valleys will split apart.

⁵ All of this will happen because the people of Israel, the descendants of Jacob, have sinned {against Yahweh}. It was {the leaders of the people in} the city of Samaria who led all of the descendants of Jacob to sin! It was {the leaders of the people in} Jerusalem who led the people of Judah {to worship idols} on the hilltops!

⁶ So Yahweh says, "I will turn the city of Samaria into a heap of rubble in the countryside; it will be a place for planting vineyards. I will roll the stones of its buildings down into the valley and strip the buildings down to their foundations.

⁷ Enemies will smash all of the idols in Samaria to pieces and burn up all the gifts that people gave at the idol temples. I will make all of the idols there into ruins because the people of Samaria collected these precious things by their business of prostitution at the temples, so enemies will carry them off and use them to pay prostitutes elsewhere."

⁸ Because of all of this, I will weep and wail. I will walk around without my sandals and without my clothes. I will howl like a jackal and cry out like a family of owls.

⁹ This is because nothing now can stop Yahweh from destroying Samaria. And because the same thing will also happen to Judah; {it is as though} the enemy army has arrived {already} at the gates of Jerusalem, the city where my people live.

¹⁰ Do not tell {our enemies in the city of} Gath {about this}! Certainly do not cry aloud! Instead, roll in the dust at Beth Leaphrah.

¹¹ You people who live in Shaphir will march away naked and ashamed. The people of Zaanen will not go out {to help you}. The people of Beth Ezel will mourn, and by their mourning {you will know that} Beth Ezel will not help you stand {against the enemy}.

¹² Indeed, the people of Maroth wait anxiously for something good to happen{, but nothing good will come}. Instead, Yahweh has caused terrible things to happen, all the way to the gates of Jerusalem.

¹³ You people of Lachish, hitch your swift horses to your war chariots {and flee}! You were the first ones to lead the people of Zion to sin, because you caused the people of Israel to rebel against Yahweh.

¹⁴ So you {leaders in Jerusalem} will have to send farewell gifts as you part with the town of Moresheth Gath{, as a father does when giving a daughter in marriage}. The town of Achzib will prove to be deceptive to the rulers of Israel.

¹⁵ You people of Mareshah, Yahweh will bring a conqueror to take over your town, as well. The honored leaders of Israel will go to Adullam {once again to hide in the cave}.

¹⁶ {You leaders of Israel,} completely shave your heads {in mourning} for the children whom you love. Shave yourselves completely bald, like an eagle, because your enemies will take your children far away from you into exile.

Micah 2:1

¹ Terrible things will happen to you who lie awake in bed at night planning how to do evil things. You get up at dawn and you do those things, simply because you are able to do them.

² You want fields that belong to other people, so you forcefully take them; you want their houses, so you steal them. You cheat people and take away their property, including what their families have owned for generations.

³ So this is what Yahweh says, "Listen to me! I am planning to destroy you people, and you will not be able to escape from it. You will no longer be able to act proudly, because you will be experiencing terrible things.

⁴ At that time, your enemies will mock you by singing this very sad song about you, 'Yahweh has completely destroyed us {Israelites}! Yahweh is taking the portions of land away from us {that he had given to us}! We are extremely distressed because he is giving our fields to our enemies!'"

⁵ So when Yahweh's people {return to} divide up the land {again}, no one from your families will be there to receive any of it.

⁶ False prophets {who hear me say this} prophesy to me, "Do not prophesy!" They do not prophesy about these things, therefore Yahweh will certainly dishonor {them}.

⁷ You descendants of Jacob should not say such things as, "Yahweh does not become impatient." Or "These are not the kinds of things that he does." What I say certainly helps those who do what is right.

⁸ {However, Yahweh says,} "Recently my people have turned against me and become my enemies. When people pass by feeling safe, like soldiers returning from battle {to their own people}, you strip the fine outer garments right off their fronts.

⁹ You force the women among my people out of the homes that they love, and you take away from their children forever the good things that I wanted to give them.

¹⁰ So get up and leave! This land is no longer a place where you can live. You have made it unacceptable to me by your sins, so I will destroy it in a way that is severe."

¹¹ If someone who speaks nothing but lies were to say, "I will preach that you should drink wine and beer!" that is the kind of prophet you people would accept.

¹² "However, some day I will certainly gather all of you descendants of Jacob. I will certainly bring together the Israelite people who survive. I will bring them together in one place, as a shepherd gathers a flock of sheep into a good pasture. They will make a lot of noise because there will be very many of them.

¹³ I will send someone who will open the way in front of them, and they will follow behind him, going out through the gate. Their king will go before them, and {I,} Yahweh, will be the one leading them."

Micah 3:1

¹ Then I said, "You leaders of the people of Jacob and you rulers of the people of Israel, listen to me! You are the ones who should know all about how to treat people fairly.

² Yet you hate what is right and love what is evil! You violently rob my people {as though} you are stripping off their skin and flesh.

³ You greedily strip my people of everything that they have {as though} you are a butcher who strips off their

skin, breaks their bones, chops them up, puts them into a cooking pot, and eats them."

⁴ Someday, {when bad things happen to those leaders,} they will call out for Yahweh {to help them}, but he will not help them. He will be as diligent to ignore them at that time, as they were to do evil deeds.

⁵ This is what Yahweh says, "This is about the prophets who are misleading my people. They prophesy good things for anyone giving them something to eat. However, they declare holy war against anyone who does not give them food.

⁶ Because of that, it will be {as though it is} always night for you prophets because you will no longer be able to see visions, and you will no longer be able to practice divination. Yes, {it will be as though} the sun has set for you prophets even during the day, because I will show you nothing."

⁷ Those who claim to see the future will feel ashamed, and those who practice divination will feel disgraced. They will all cover their faces to express how ashamed they are, because God will not answer them.

⁸ But as for me, Yahweh's Spirit greatly empowers me to do what is right and to be strong so that I can tell the people of Jacob how they have rebelled {against God} and tell the people of Israel how they have sinned.

⁹ You leaders of the people of Jacob and you rulers of the people of Israel, listen to this! You are the ones who hate it when people do what is right, and when people say what is true, you change it into something false.

¹⁰ You are getting the wealth to build up Jerusalem by murdering people and treating people unjustly.

¹¹ The city's leaders decide cases {favorably} only for those who give them bribes. The city's priests teach only when people pay them {well}. The city's prophets require people to pay them money in order to tell them what they think will happen to them. Yet those same leaders trust in Yahweh and say, "Yahweh is among us, so nothing bad will happen to us."

¹² So, because of what you leaders are doing, enemies will make Mount Zion look like a field that a farmer has plowed. Jerusalem will become a pile of rubble, and the temple hill will become an overgrown forest.

Micah 4:1

¹ But Yahweh says that in the latter days, the mountain where his temple stands will become the most important of all the mountains. Yes, Yahweh will cause it

to be the most important place, and a lot of people from many different people groups will come there {to worship}.

² {People from} many nations will gather and say {to each other}, “Let us go to the mountain where Yahweh is, to the temple where we can worship the God whom Jacob worshiped. There God will teach us how he wants us to live, and we will do what he tells us to do.” Indeed, Zion is the place from which God will send out his instructions, and from Jerusalem Yahweh will announce his messages.

³ Yahweh will settle disputes among many peoples and will make decisions for powerful nations that are far away. Then those peoples will reshape their implements of war into implements for farming. {Armies of} nations will no longer fight against {armies of} other nations, and people will no longer train to be soldiers.

⁴ Everyone will sit {peacefully} under his own grapevines and under his own fig trees, and no one will cause any of them to be afraid. That will certainly happen because Yahweh, the commander of the heavenly armies, has commanded it.

⁵ Even though each one of all of the other people groups obeys its own god, as for us, we will obey Yahweh our God forever.

⁶ Yahweh says, “At that time I will gather the people who are injured and those who are scattered, that is, everyone whom I have caused to suffer.

⁷ I will cause the injured ones to be the faithful survivors of my people and I will cause all of those whom I drove away to become a mighty nation. Then {I} Yahweh will rule over them on Mount Zion, now and forever.

⁸ You people of Zion, who are like a watchtower on the hill guarding my people, I will again authorize you to rule. Jerusalem will once again be the capitol of my kingdom.

⁹ {But} now you are crying out, and it is not because you have no king, or because your advisors have all died. You act as though you are suffering greatly, as much as a woman who is birthing a child!

¹⁰ People of Zion, you should agonize and wail like a woman birthing a child, because now you must leave this city and live out in the open fields. You will go all the way to Babylon. However, while you are there, {I} Yahweh will rescue you. That is where he will take you away from your enemies.

¹¹ But now {the armies of} many nations have gathered to attack you. They are saying, ‘We are here to destroy {this city}! We want to see the ruins of Zion!’

¹² But as for them, they do not know what {I} Yahweh am thinking. They do not understand that this is what I have planned {for them}. In fact, I have gathered them together {to destroy them}, just as a farmer gathers grain onto a threshing floor {to crush it}.

¹³ So you people of Zion, become active and defeat your enemies! You can do this because I will cause you to be very strong. So destroy {these} many peoples and give to {me} Yahweh, the Ruler of the whole earth, everything valuable that your enemies possess.”

Micah 5:1

¹ Now, people {of Jerusalem}, gather yourselves into a troop! Even though you have a wall to protect your city, enemy soldiers have surrounded it. They are here to overpower and humiliate the ruler of Israel.

² However, {I have something to say about} Bethlehem in the region of Ephrathah. Even though the clan that lives there is the smallest of the clans of Judah, someone who will rule Israel for me will come from that town. He has been active since ancient times, from eternity.

³ So God will allow Israel’s enemies to conquer them, until the time when she who will bear gives birth. Then the rest of those who, with him, are part of Israel will rejoin their fellow Israelites.

⁴ Yahweh will strengthen him to rule and to care for his people as majestically and authoritatively as if Yahweh, his God, were doing those things himself. His people will live {safely}, because, at that time, people all over the earth will honor him.

⁵ He will cause his people to prosper. When {the army of} Assyria attacks our land and breaks through our fortresses, we will appoint many leaders {to lead our army} to fight against them.

⁶ They will lead our army to rule the land of Assyria, that is, the territory that Nimrod founded {long ago}. The ruler will rescue us from the Assyrians when they cross our borders to invade our land.

⁷ Then the descendants of Jacob who have survived will live among many other peoples. {They will be a blessing for those peoples,} just as the dew and the rain {are} that Yahweh sends for the grass. They will depend on Yahweh {to sustain them} just as the grass does, and not on other people.

⁸ Yes, the descendants of Jacob who have survived will be in other nations, living among many other peoples. But they will be {powerful,} like a lion is among the other animals. If they need to do so, they can easily defeat those peoples, just as a young lion pounces on sheep and tears them apart, and no one can rescue them.

⁹ {Yahweh,} we want you to powerfully defeat all of your enemies and to destroy them completely!

¹⁰ Yahweh declares, “At that time, I will take away your {war} horses and I will destroy your chariots.

¹¹ I will tear down the cities in your land and I will destroy all of your fortresses.

¹² I will stop you from practicing witchcraft, and there will be no more fortune tellers among you.

¹³ I will destroy your idols and your sacred stone pillars, and then you will no longer worship things that you yourselves have made.

¹⁴ I will remove the {poles that you use to worship the goddess} Asherah, and I will destroy your cities.

¹⁵ Because I am very angry, I will severely punish {the people of} the nations that have not obeyed {me}.”

Micah 6:1

¹ Listen, {everyone,} because Yahweh has something to say, “{Micah,} stand up and present {my} case, and let the mountains and the hills be witnesses to what you say.”

² {It as though} the mountains and the enduring foundations of the earth are listening as Yahweh contends {against his people}. Indeed, Yahweh is bringing charges against his people; he is about to argue his case against Israel.

³ {Yahweh says,}“My people, you act as though I have harmed you! You treat me as though I have made things difficult for you! If you can accuse me of anything, then do it now!

⁴ Instead of doing bad things, I brought your ancestors out of Egypt, rescuing them from the place where they had lived as slaves. I sent Moses to lead them, along with {his older brother} Aaron and {his older sister} Miriam.

⁵ My people, remember when Balak, the king of Moab, wanted to conspire with Balaam son of Beor {to curse your ancestors}, and think about how Balaam answered him. Remember what happened {as your ancestors traveled} from Shittim to Gilgal, so that you

may recognize that {I,} Yahweh, have always done the right things for you.”

⁶ {An Israelite asks,} “What should I bring when I come to Yahweh, the God who lives in the highest {heaven}, and bow down before him? Should I bring offerings to burn; should I bring one-year-old calves {as sacrifices}?

⁷ Will Yahweh accept thousands of rams or vast quantities of olive oil? Should I sacrifice my firstborn child to pay for my sin? Can a sacrifice from my physical body compensate for my spiritual sin?”

⁸ {No!} Yahweh has already told you, human person, what is good and that he wants from you only this: He wants you to do what is just, to love being faithful to others, and to conduct yourself humbly as you live before your God.

⁹ Yahweh is calling out a message to the people of the city {of Jerusalem}. (Truly wise people revere you, Yahweh.) Listen carefully, you tribe {of Israel} and all {leaders} that Yahweh has appointed!

¹⁰ “It disgusts me that wicked people still have wealth in their houses that they got by cheating others, and that they use measures that are smaller than they should be. This is something that I have cursed.

¹¹ No one is innocent who uses dishonest scales or a bag of deceptive weights.

¹² The rich people in this city always act violently to others. All of the people who live here tell lies. Yes, they always speak deceitfully.

¹³ For my part, I will attack you severely. I will ruin you because of your sins.

¹⁴ As for you, you will eat {food}, but it will not satisfy you because it will rush right through you. You will try to save {people}, but you will not be able to rescue {anyone} and even if you do rescue a few, I will allow enemies to kill them.

¹⁵ As for you, you will plant crops, but you will not harvest them. As for you, you will press olives, but you will not get to use the olive oil. Yes, also with the wine—you will crush grapes, but you will not get to drink any of it.

¹⁶ These things will happen because you follow the {wicked} laws that King Omri established and do all of the {evil} things that King Ahab and his descendants practiced. You have lived according to what they advised, so I will destroy your city and cause people of other nations to scorn everyone who lives there. Other peoples will detest you, because that is what my people deserve.”

Micah 7:1

¹ I am very miserable! It is because I am {very frustrated} like someone who looks for fruit to pick after everyone else has already picked all of the summer fruit and harvested all of the grapes. I am like someone who cannot find a single cluster of grapes to eat or an early fig, which he longs for.

² {I am looking for} faithful people, but all of them have disappeared from the land, and there are no longer any honest people among us. All of the people who remain are eager to kill others; each person tries to find ways to exploit his fellow citizens.

³ They are energetic and skillful in doing evil things. Government officials and judges demand bribes. Powerful people tell others what they want for themselves, and they all plot together to get it done.

⁴ Even the best people among them are harmful, and even those who seem the most honest, cause people pain. The time that the prophets foretold, the time when God will punish those who do evil things, is coming soon. This is when they will panic.

⁵ So, do not trust anyone, not even a neighbor or a friend. Be careful what you say even to your own wife!

⁶ Indeed, even sons treat their fathers contemptuously, and daughters defy their mothers. Daughters-in-law defy their mothers-in-law. A person's enemies are the people who live in his own household.

⁷ But as for me, I will watch to see what Yahweh will do {to help me}. I intend to wait confidently for God, who saves me. The God whom I worship will listen when I call to him.

⁸ You who are our enemies, do not celebrate over what has happened to us, because even though you have defeated us, we will recover. Even though it looks like everything is bad for us, Yahweh will take care of us.

⁹ We will patiently endure whatever Yahweh does to punish us, because we have sinned against him. Eventually he will defend us and make things right for us. He will change everything bad around us to good, and we will see that he always does what is right.

¹⁰ I want my enemies to see the same thing, and then everyone will completely despise them. They are the ones who mocked me by saying, "Yahweh your God is not helping you at all!" But at that time I will watch as people destroy the homes of my enemies, making them just like the mud in the streets.

¹¹ {People of Zion,} the day is coming when you will rebuild your walls! On that day, your city will extend far beyond its present boundaries.

¹² On that day people will come to you {from everywhere}. The places they will come from will be from Assyria to Egypt, and from Egypt all the way to the Euphrates River, from one sea to another and from every mountain.

¹³ {In contrast} {the rest of} the earth will become an empty wasteland because of the {evil} things its people have done.

¹⁴ {Yahweh,} protect and guide your people, as a shepherd does for his sheep! They are the people whom you have chosen to belong to you. They are like sheep that live apart from others in a wooded area of Mount Carmel, but give them the rich pasturelands of the Bashan and Gilead regions that they enjoyed long ago.

¹⁵ {Yahweh says,} "Yes, just as I did long ago when I rescued your ancestors from Egypt, I will do amazing things for you."

¹⁶ People from many nations will see {what Yahweh does for his people}, and what they see will humiliate them because they thought that they were powerful, but they are not. They will be so amazed that they will be unable to say or hear anything.

¹⁷ They will grovel on the ground like a snake, like an insect in the dirt. {They will be so afraid that} they will come trembling from their fortresses. They will be very afraid as they approach Yahweh, the God whom we worship. They will be afraid because of you, {Yahweh}.

¹⁸ {Yahweh,} no other God is like you! You forgive the sins of the people who have remained faithful to you, those who belong to you. You do not stay angry forever because you are the one who delights in faithfully loving us.

¹⁹ You will be merciful to us once again. You will completely forgive all of our sins, as though you are throwing them into the deepest part of the ocean.

²⁰ You will show the descendants of Jacob that you are trustworthy, and you will faithfully love the descendants of Abraham, just as you solemnly promised to our ancestors long ago.